IDEATION PHASE

Define the Problem Statements

Date	16 October 2026
Team ID	
Project Name	Software Installation Request – ServiceNow
Maximum Marks	2 Marks

Customer Problem Statement

A customer problem statement explains the situation from the user's point of view. It identifies who faces the problem, what they want to do, what makes the task difficult, why the difficulty happens, and how it affects them. In this project, the main customer is an employee who needs software installed for work.

Statement Element	Customer Perspective
I am (Customer)	An employee who needs a software application installed on a work computer to perform daily tasks or complete job responsibilities.
I'm trying to	Submit a software installation request with the software name, required version, business reason, and urgency, then receive the software after the required approval.
But	I may not know the correct request process, may provide incomplete information, may need to wait for manager approval, or may not know whether a software license is available.
Because	Software requests require business approval and fulfillment by a support team. License availability can affect when installation can be completed. Without a structured process, request details, task ownership, and progress updates can be difficult to follow.
Which makes me feel	Uncertain about the request status, delayed in completing work, and inconvenienced when I need to follow up to learn whether the software can be installed.

Problem Statements

Problem	I am	I'm trying to	But	Because	Which makes me feel
PS-1	An employee who needs work-related software.	Request software installation and receive the required version.	I may not know the request status, approval progress, or license availability.	The request must be approved and fulfilled by support staff, and a license may not be immediately available.	Uncertain and delayed in completing my work.
PS-2	A manager or Software Support Team member responsible for reviewing or fulfilling requests.	Review requests, make approval decisions, assign fulfillment work, and communicate the result.	Requests may lack required details, and follow-ups can make ownership and progress harder to track.	Request information, approval, task assignment, task status, and requester communication must be coordinated.	Concerned about rework, unclear responsibility, and delays to employees.

Customer Problem Statement – Detailed Explanation

Employees need a reliable way to request software required for their work. A request can involve several activities: identifying the correct software and version, explaining the business need, obtaining manager approval, assigning the work to a support team, checking license availability, and confirming the installation result. If these activities are not connected through a clear process, employees may not know who is handling the request or when they can expect the software. Support staff may also spend extra time asking for missing details or responding to status enquiries.

The problem becomes more noticeable when a license is unavailable. The request cannot be completed immediately, and the employee needs an honest update about the reason for the delay and the expected time. The process should therefore handle both successful installation and license-related delays.

Proposed Direction

The proposed solution is a Software Installation Request catalog item in the ServiceNow Service Catalog, supported by a Flow Designer process. The catalog item collects the software name, version, business reason, and urgency. The flow sends the Requested Item to the requester's manager for approval. When approved, it creates a Catalog Task for the Software Support Team and monitors the task until an outcome is recorded.

Process Stage	How the proposed solution addresses the problem
1. Submit request	The employee uses one catalog item and provides the software name, version, business reason, and urgency needed by support staff.
2. Manager approval	Flow Designer routes the request to the requester's manager. Fulfillment proceeds only when the approval outcome is Approved.
3. Support fulfillment	The flow creates a Catalog Task linked to the Requested Item and assigns it to the Software Support Team.
4. Completion or delay	A separate Wait For Condition monitors the Catalog Task. Closed Complete follows the success path; Pending is used in this project to indicate a license is unavailable.
5. Notify employee	A personalized email confirms successful installation or explains that a new license is needed and the expected delay is approximately one week.
6. License issue record	A separate Business Rule on Requested Item [sc_req_item] creates an Incident when the Requested Item is moved to On Hold for a license issue.

Customer Needs

- A single, clear place to submit software installation requests.
- Simple fields for software name, version, business reason, and urgency.
- A clear approval process and responsibility for fulfillment.
- A task assigned to the Software Support Team after manager approval.
- A clear notification when installation is complete or a license is unavailable.
- An estimated delay of approximately one week when a new license must be obtained.

Project-specific clarification: The Catalog Task state choices available in this project did not include On Hold, so Pending was selected as the project's signal for a license shortage in the flow. This is a project convention, not a universal meaning of the ServiceNow Pending state. The separate Incident Business Rule uses the Requested Item's On Hold state as its condition. The solution uses Flow Designer; Legacy Workflow is not used.